

Chapter 7.1

General stowage provisions

7.1.1 Introduction

This chapter contains the general provisions for the stowage of dangerous goods in all types of ships. Specific provisions applicable to, container ships, ro-ro ships, general cargo ships and barge-carrying ships, are stipulated in chapters 7.4 to 7.7.

7.1.2 Definitions

Note 1: The term “magazine” is no longer used in the context of the IMDG Code. A magazine that is not a fixed part of the ship shall meet the provisions for a closed cargo transport unit for class 1 (see 7.1.2). A magazine that is a fixed part of the ship such as compartment, below deck area or hold shall meet the provisions of 7.6.2.4.

Note 2: Cargo holds cannot be interpreted as closed cargo transport units.

Clear of living quarters means that packages or cargo transport units shall be stowed a minimum distance of 3 m from accommodation, air intakes, machinery spaces and other enclosed work areas.

Closed cargo transport unit for class 1 means a unit which fully encloses the contents by permanent structures, can be secured to the ship's structure and is, except for division 1.4, structurally serviceable as defined in this section. Cargo transport units with fabric sides or tops are not closed cargo transport units. The floor of any closed cargo transport unit shall either be constructed of wood, close-boarded, or so arranged that goods are stowed on sparred gratings, wooden pallets or dunnage.

Combustible material means material which may or may not be dangerous goods but which is easily ignited and supports combustion. Examples of combustible materials include wood, paper, straw, vegetable fibres, products made from such materials, coal, lubricants, and oils. This definition does not apply to packaging material or dunnage.

Potential sources of ignition means, but is not limited to, open fires, machinery exhausts, galley uptakes, electrical outlets and electrical equipment including those on refrigerated or heated cargo transport units unless they are of certified safe type.

Protected from sources of heat means that packages and cargo transport units shall be stowed at least 2.4 m from heated ship structures, where the surface temperature is liable to exceed 55°C. Examples of heated structures are steam pipes, heating coils, top or side walls of heated fuel and cargo tanks, and bulkheads of machinery spaces. In addition, packages not loaded inside a cargo transport unit and stowed on deck shall be shaded from direct sunlight. The surface of a cargo transport unit can heat rapidly when in direct sunlight in nearly windless conditions and the cargo may also become heated. Depending on the nature of the goods in the cargo transport unit and the planned voyage precautions shall be taken to ensure that exposure to direct sunlight is reduced.

Stowage means the proper placement of dangerous goods on board a ship in order to ensure safety and environmental protection during transport.

Stowage on deck means stowage on the weather deck. For open ro-ro cargo spaces see 7.5.2.6.

Stowage under deck means any stowage that is not on the weather deck. For hatchless container ships see 7.4.2.1.

Structurally serviceable for class 1 means the cargo transport unit shall not have major defects in its structural components, e.g. top and bottom rails, top and bottom end rails, door sill and header, floor cross-members, corner posts, and corner fittings in a freight container. Major defects are: dents or bends in the structural

members greater than 19 mm in depth, regardless of length; cracks or breaks in structural members; more than one splice (e.g. a lapped splice) in top or bottom end rails or door headers; more than two splices in any one top or bottom side rail or any splice in a door sill or corner post; door hinges and hardware that are seized, twisted, broken, missing or otherwise inoperative; gaskets and seals that do not seal; or, for freight containers, any distortion of the overall configuration great enough to prevent proper alignment of handling equipment, mounting and securing on chassis or vehicle, or insertion into ship's cells. In addition, deterioration in any component of the cargo transport unit, regardless of the material of construction, such as rusted-out metal in sidewalls or disintegrated fibreglass, is unacceptable. Normal wear, however, including oxidation (rust), slight dents and scratches and other damage that does not affect serviceability or the weathertight integrity of the units, is acceptable.

7.1.3 Stowage categories

7.1.3.1 Stowage categories for class 1

Dangerous goods of class 1 other than division 1.4, compatibility group S, packed in limited quantities shall be stowed as indicated in column 16a of the Dangerous Goods List in accordance with one of the categories specified below.

Stowage category 01	Cargo ships (up to 12 passengers)	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck
	Passenger ships	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck
Stowage category 02	Cargo ships (up to 12 passengers)	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck
	Passenger ships	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck in closed cargo transport unit in accordance with 7.1.4.4.6
Stowage category 03	Cargo ships (up to 12 passengers)	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck
	Passenger ships	Prohibited except if in accordance with 7.1.4.4.6
Stowage category 04	Cargo ships (up to 12 passengers)	On deck in closed cargo transport unit or under deck in closed cargo transport unit
	Passenger ships	Prohibited except if in accordance with 7.1.4.4.6
Stowage category 05	Cargo ships (up to 12 passengers)	On deck only in closed cargo transport unit
	Passenger ships	Prohibited except if in accordance with 7.1.4.4.6

7.1.3.2 Stowage categories for classes 2 to 9

Dangerous goods of classes 2 to 9 and division 1.4, compatibility group S, packed in limited quantities shall be stowed as indicated in column 16a of the Dangerous Goods List in accordance with one of the categories specified below:

Stowage category A

Cargo ships or passenger ships carrying a number of passengers limited to not more than 25 or to 1 passenger per 3 m of overall length, whichever is the greater number	}	ON DECK OR UNDER DECK
Other passenger ships in which the limiting number of passengers transported is exceeded		

Stowage category B

Cargo ships or passenger ships carrying a number of passengers limited to not more than 25 or to 1 passenger per 3 m of overall length, whichever is the greater number	}	ON DECK OR UNDER DECK
Other passenger ships in which the limiting number of passengers transported is exceeded		

Stowage category C

Cargo ships or passenger ships carrying a number of passengers limited to not more than 25 or to 1 passenger per 3 m of overall length, whichever is the greater number	}	ON DECK ONLY
Other passenger ships in which the limiting number of passengers transported is exceeded		ON DECK ONLY

Stowage category D

Cargo ships or passenger ships carrying a number of passengers limited to not more than 25 or to 1 passenger per 3 m of overall length, whichever is the greater number	}	ON DECK ONLY
Other passenger ships in which the limiting number of passengers transported is exceeded		PROHIBITED

Stowage category E

Cargo ships or passenger ships carrying a number of passengers limited to not more than 25 or to 1 passenger per 3 m of overall length, whichever is the greater number	}	ON DECK OR UNDER DECK
Other passenger ships in which the limiting number of passengers transported is exceeded		PROHIBITED

7.1.4 Special stowage provisions

7.1.4.1 Stowage of empty uncleaned packagings, including IBCs and large packagings

Notwithstanding the stowage provisions given in the Dangerous Goods List, empty uncleaned packagings, including IBCs and large packagings, which shall be stowed *on deck only* when full may be stowed *on deck or under deck* in a mechanically ventilated cargo space. However, empty uncleaned pressure receptacles which carry a label of class 2.3 shall be stowed *on deck only* (see also 4.1.1.11) and waste aerosols shall only be stowed according to column 16a of the Dangerous Goods List.

7.1.4.2 Stowage of marine pollutants and infectious substances of UN 2814, UN 2900 and UN 3549

Where stowage is permitted *on deck or under deck*, *under deck* stowage is preferred. Where stowage *on deck only* is required, preference shall be given to stowage on well-protected decks or to stowage inboard in sheltered areas of exposed decks.

7.1.4.3 Stowage of limited quantities and excepted quantities

For the stowage of limited quantities and excepted quantities see chapters 3.4 and 3.5.

7.1.4.4 Stowage of goods of class 1

7.1.4.4.1 In cargo ships of 500 gross tons or over and passenger ships constructed before 1 September 1984 and in cargo ships of less than 500 gross tons constructed before 1 February 1992, goods of class 1 with the exception of division 1.4, compatibility group S, shall be stowed *on deck only*, unless otherwise approved by the Administration.

7.1.4.4.2 Goods of class 1 with the exception of division 1.4 shall be stowed not less than a horizontal distance of 12 m from living quarters, life-saving appliances and areas where the ship's passengers can access without any authorization or limitation.

7.1.4.4.3 Goods of class 1 with the exception of division 1.4 shall not be positioned closer to the ship's side than a distance equal to one eighth of the beam or 2.4 m, whichever is the lesser.

7.1.4.4.4 Goods of class 1 shall not be stowed within a horizontal distance of 6 m from potential sources of ignition.

7.1.4.4.5 *Transport to or from offshore oil platforms, mobile offshore drilling units and other offshore installations*

Notwithstanding the stowage category indicated in column 16a of the Dangerous Goods List, UN 0124 JET PERFORATING GUNS, CHARGED, and UN 0494 JET PERFORATING GUNS, CHARGED, transported to or from offshore oil platforms, mobile offshore drilling units and other offshore installations may be stowed on deck in offshore well tool pallets, cradles or baskets provided that:

- .1 initiation devices shall be segregated from each other and from any jet perforating guns in accordance with the provisions of 7.2.7, and from any other dangerous goods in accordance with the provisions of 7.2.4 and 7.6.3.2, unless otherwise approved by the competent authority;